

6 290100 002354

FRIDAY
MARCH 20, 2026
SHAWWAL 1, 1447

gulfnews.com
GULF NEWS



LIVE
UPDATES

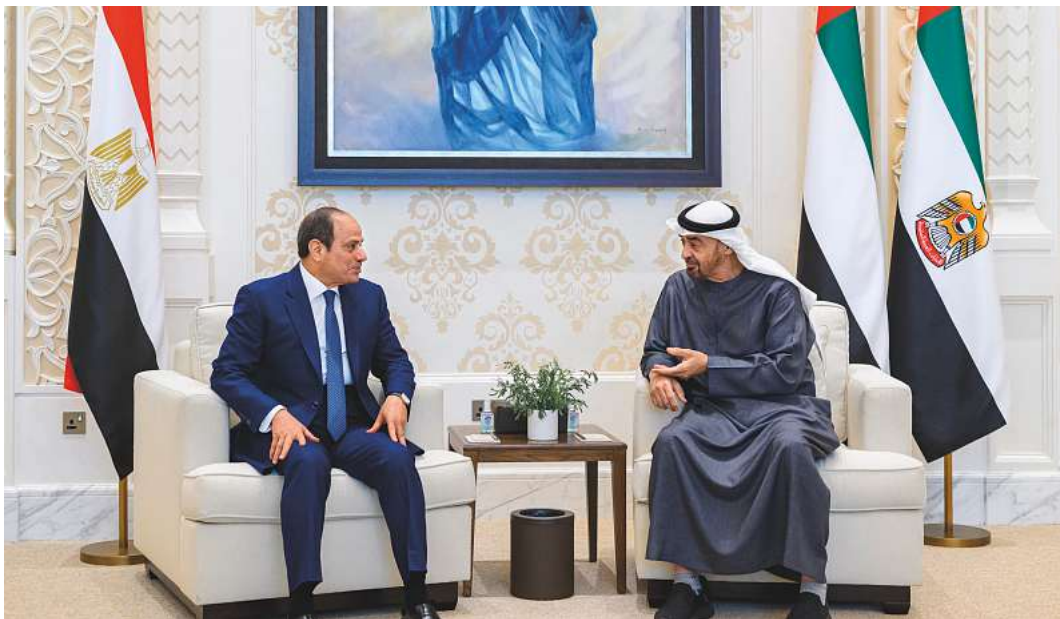
eid
Mubarak



ABC
CARGO & COURIER

800 916
www.abccargo.com

3142925 3.1



UAE Presidential Court

MOHAMED, AL SISSI DISCUSS REGIONAL DEVELOPMENTS

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan met Abdul Fattah Al Sissi, President of Egypt, yesterday. During the meeting, the leaders discussed bilateral cooperation, particularly in the economic and development fields. They also addressed developments in the Middle East amid ongoing military escalation and their serious implications for regional and international security and stability. Al Sissi reiterated Egypt's condemnation of the blatant Iranian attacks targeting the UAE and a number of other countries in the region. In this regard, Al Sissi affirmed Egypt's solidarity with the UAE in the measures it is taking to uphold its security, territorial integrity, and the safety of its people.

Celebrate safely and with peace of mind, authorities assure

UAE citizens and residents gear up to enjoy Eid festivities

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

With today being the first day of Eid Al Fitr, residents and expatriates in the UAE have done their Eid shopping ahead of time, balancing great anticipation with practical planning to avoid last-minute crowds.

From malls to neighbourhood markets, the spirit of the season remains visible amid ongoing developments, with shoppers focusing on what the celebration truly means.

Some residents have noted that they prefer to complete their Eid shopping in advance to avoid long queues and crowded stores during the holiday.

Meanwhile, authorities have issued fresh guidance to ensure



Afra Al Nofelli/Gulf News

■ Eid Al Fitr decorations light up Marina Mall in Abu Dhabi.

that residents and visitors alike can celebrate safely and with peace of mind.

The Dubai Media Office has released a safety guide explaining what to do if you receive an emergency alert on your phone, which can happen anytime, even during Eid. Abu Dhabi

Police and Abu Dhabi Civil Defence Authority are at the front lines of making sure the Eid Al Fitr holiday is celebrated safely.

Sharjah City Municipality announced full readiness, launching intensive inspection and awareness campaigns.

SEE ALSO P2, 4, 11

UAE denies reports of capital movement restrictions

Gargash: Economic model is built on openness and free movement of capital

DUBAI
BY KHITAM ALAMIR
Chief News Editor

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, has dismissed rumours about restrictions on capital movement in the country, warning against the spread of misinformation during times of regional tension.

In a post on the social media platform X, Gargash said the UAE had repeatedly cautioned against the dangers of rumours during periods of conflict, stressing that claims about capital controls had been clearly denied by authorities.

He reaffirmed that the UAE's economic model has long been built on openness and the free movement of capital, describing these principles as central to the country's growth and its position as a leading global investment destination.

Earlier, the UAE Ministry of Economy and Tourism had denied reports and claims circulated on some platforms regarding the imposition of restrictions by the UAE on capital movement or preventing foreign investors from transferring or disposing of their funds in accordance with the relevant regulations.

The ministry stressed the UAE's firm commitment to policies of economic openness and the free movement of capital and called on the public and media to verify information and rely only on official sources.

IRAN HITS KEY GULF ENERGY SITES AS WAR ESCALATES

Energy must not be weaponised, UAE warns

DUBAI

BY STEPHEN N. R.
Senior Associate Editor

Oil and gas prices surged sharply yesterday after Iran struck major energy facilities across the Gulf, deepening fears of a widening conflict that could disrupt global supplies and push the Middle East war into a dangerous new phase.

Brent crude jumped as much as 10 per cent, while European gas prices spiked up to 35 per cent after Qatar reported "extensive" damage to its Ras Laffan liquefied natural gas (LNG) facility — the largest of its kind in the world — following Iranian strikes. The attacks marked a major escalation, as Tehran targeted critical energy infrastructure in retaliation for an Israeli strike on its South Pars gas field, part of the world's largest natural gas reserve.

No respite

In Saudi Arabia, a strike hit the SAMREF refinery in the Red Sea port of Yanbu, raising concerns over the security of alternative export routes designed to bypass the Strait of Hormuz, the vital oil chokepoint now under pressure.

The Yanbu facility is linked to Petroline, a key pipeline that allows Saudi crude to be shipped westward to the Red Sea, avoiding the Gulf route increasingly threatened by the conflict. In Kuwait, fires broke out at the Mina Abdullah and Mina Al Ahmadi refineries — with a combined ca-

STABILITY BY DESIGN

The UAE's response to regional attacks and tensions reflects an advanced model of a state capable of managing crises with high efficiency and resilience, particularly within a complex regional environment marked by rapid developments and overlapping interests. The UAE has demonstrated a strong ability to absorb the shock of crises — not only through immediate measures, but through an integrated system that combines security readiness, economic flexibility, and a long-term strategic vision.

— **Abdulla Rasheed,**
Abu Dhabi Editor
SEE ALSO P5

capacity of around 800,000 barrels per day — though authorities later said the blazes were contained.

The wave of attacks has heightened fears of sustained disruption to global energy flows, particularly as facilities central to production, processing and export come under repeated strikes.

At a meeting in Saudi Arabia, Arab and Islamic foreign ministers condemned the strikes on Gulf energy infrastructure and warned they could further escalate the conflict. Qatar warned damage to Ras Laffan could delay supplies even after conflict ends.

The escalation has been compounded by rising risks to mari-

time routes. Iran's grip over the Strait of Hormuz — through which roughly a fifth of global oil passes — has already slowed shipping, tightening supply and pushing prices higher. US President Donald Trump warned Iran to halt attacks on Gulf energy infrastructure, threatening that Washington could "massively blow up" the entire South Pars gas field if strikes continue.

Conflicting signals

In a post on social media, Trump also said the United States "knew nothing" about Israel's earlier attack on South Pars, even as he insisted that "no more attacks" would be carried out on the site if Iran de-escalates. The conflicting signals have added to uncertainty over the trajectory of the war, now increasingly centred on energy assets.

The UAE warned that targeting energy infrastructure could have far-reaching global consequences. "Energy infrastructure should never be a target," said UAE Minister of Industry and Advanced Technology Dr Sultan Al Jaber, adding that such attacks threaten not just regional stability but global economic security.

The United Nations also sounded the alarm, with Secretary-General Antonio Guterres urging the United States and Israel to end the war before it spirals "out of control." "To the United States and to Israel: It's high time to end this war," he said, warning of "tragic consequences" for civilians and the global economy.

SEE ALSO P7-10, 12, 13

THE VIEWS

Eid amid 'digital debris': Celebrate responsibly in the UAE | P6

BUSINESS

Emirati startup aims to prove UAE can build advanced mobility tech | P9

Subscribe in print and online

www.store.gulfnews.com

www.gulfnews.com/subscriptions

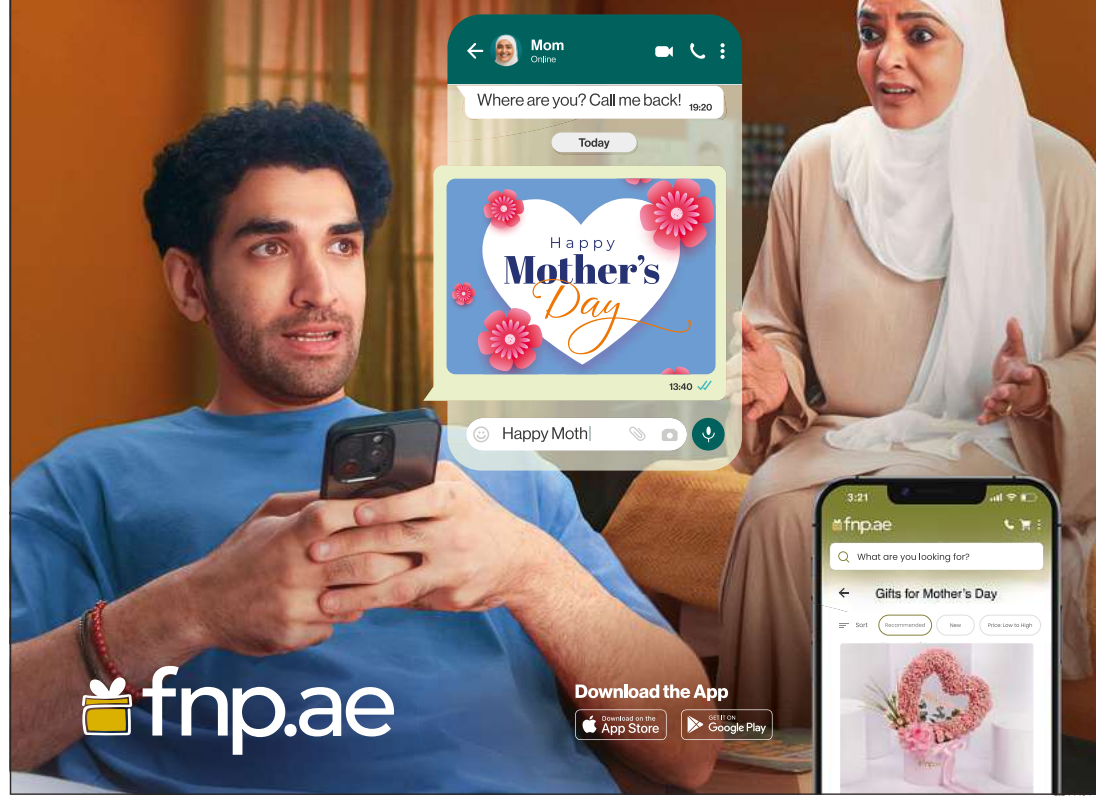
Tel: 600 587 234

E-mail: circ@gulfnews.com

PRICE
UAE: Dh 5.00
Bahrain: BD 0.500
Oman: RO 0.500
India: Rs 40.00
S.Arabia: SR 5.00
Pakistan: Rs 100.00

It's Mother's Day!
A text is not going to cut it.
Gift it like you mean it!

Make Mother's Day extra special with a thoughtful gift. At fnp.ae, discover thousands of meaningful options with 60-minute delivery across the UAE. Flowers, cakes, hampers, and out-of-the-box surprises, delivered right when it counts.



3144494 6.1